A Moving Map of Global Science

14,002 research institutions placed by scholar mobility, one map per year, 2008–2025

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Data: OpenAlex

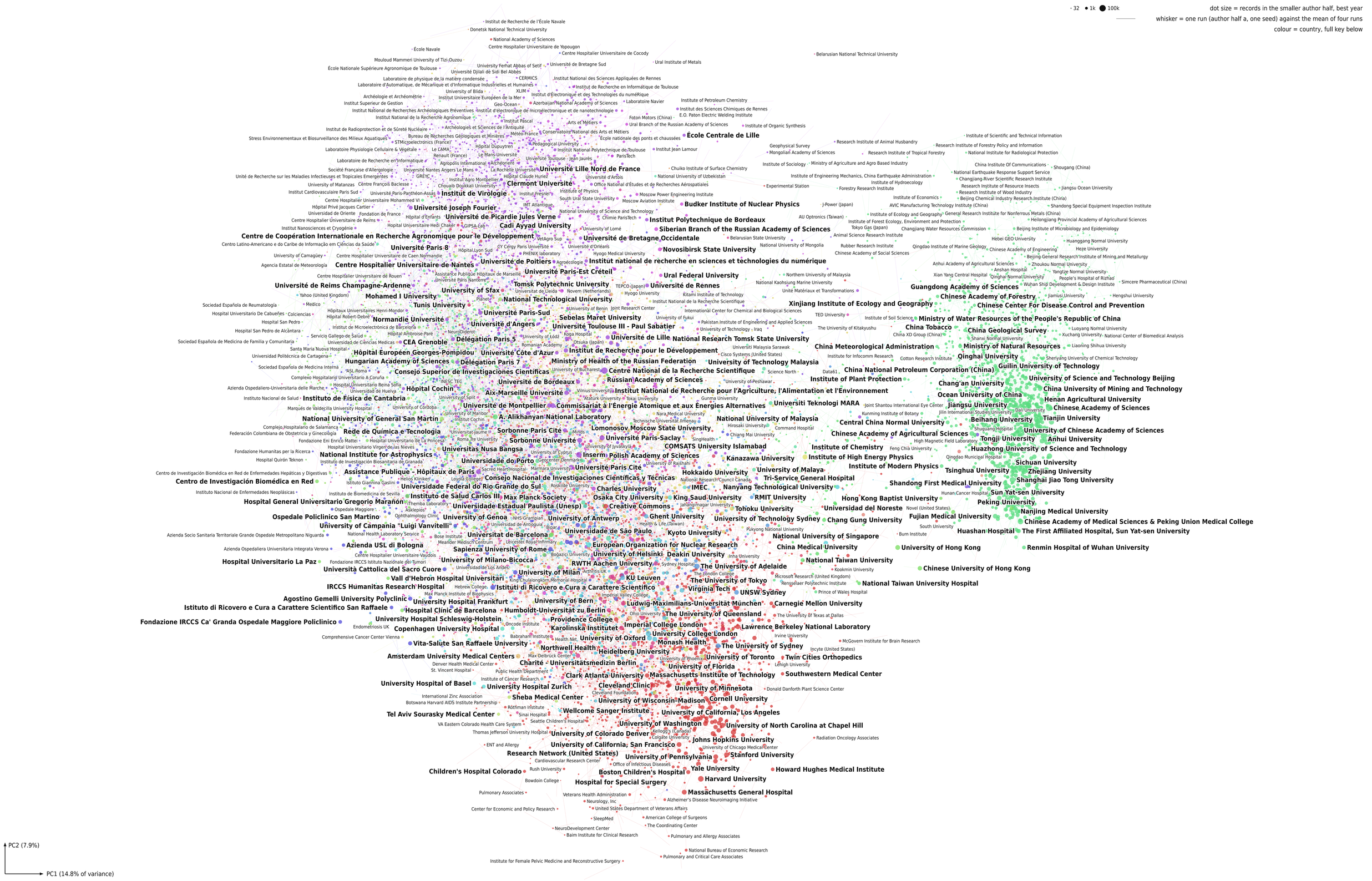
THE MAP 2025

proximity = exchanging scholars, not geography; PC1 × PC2 of the aligned yearly maps

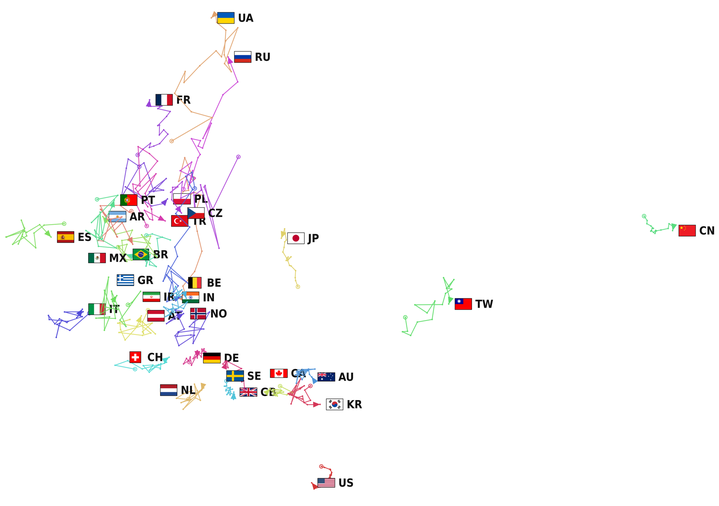
· 32 ● 1k ⬤ 100k — dot size = records in the smaller author half, best year

whisker = one run (author half a, one seed) against the mean of four runs

colour = country, full key below



COUNTRY PATHS country centroids 2008→2025



CLOSEST TO THE ORIGIN 2025

origin = the all-year mean of world science; d over all 5 components; evidence ≥ 4,096

		d
1	North Carolina State University	0.223
2	University of Alberta	0.255
3	The University of Western Australia	0.261
4	Purdue University West Lafayette	0.263
5	Pennsylvania State University	0.265
6	University of Maryland, College Park	0.272
7	University of Ottawa	0.272
8	The University of Texas at Arlington	0.275
9	Mahidol University	0.278
10	National Research Council	0.287
11	Western University	0.288
12	Lomonosov Moscow State University	0.290
13	University of Tennessee at Knoxville	0.294
14	Agency for Science, Technology and Research	0.295
15	University of Belgrade	0.299
16	Tehran University of Medical Sciences	0.300
17	Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México	0.305
18	Carnegie Mellon University	0.305
19	Consejo Nacional de Investigaciones Científicas y Técnicas	0.306
20	King Saud University	0.314
21	Arizona State University	0.316
22	Texas A&M University	0.316
23	McMaster University	0.320
24	Southern University and Agricultural and Mechanical College	0.324
25	McGill University	0.327
26	Michigan State University	0.328
27	The University of Texas at Austin	0.328
28	Russian Academy of Sciences	0.330
29	Polish Academy of Sciences	0.333
30	University of Auckland	0.336
31	University of Calgary	0.339
32	University of Nottingham	0.341
33	The University of Adelaide	0.344
34	University of Helsinki	0.345
35	National University of Singapore	0.348
36	Jagiellonian University	0.349
37	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	0.351
38	Ghent University	0.352
39	University of British Columbia	0.354
40	Australian National University	0.354
41	King Abdulaziz University	0.359
42	UNSW Sydney	0.360
43	Leiden University Medical Center	0.360
44	Shahid Beheshti University of Medical Sciences	0.362
45	Charles University	0.363
46	The University of Queensland	0.364
47	Georgia Institute of Technology	0.365
48	University of Southern Denmark	0.367
49	University of Toronto	0.367
50	University of Florida	0.367
51	Aarhus University	0.368
52	University of Arizona	0.368
53	University of Gothenburg	0.370
54	ETH Zurich	0.370
55	Technical University of Denmark	0.371
56	Lund University	0.372
57	Erasmus MC	0.374
58	National and Kapodistrian University of Athens	0.375
59	Kurchatov Institute	0.380
60	Norwegian University of Science and Technology	0.381
61	University of Turin	0.382
62	German Cancer Research Center	0.384
63	National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine	0.384
64	University of Padua	0.384
65	Karolinska Institutet	0.386
66	University Health Network	0.387
67	Tel Aviv University	0.388
68	University Medical Center Groningen	0.388
69	University of Oslo	0.391
70	University of Pisa	0.394
71	LMU Klinikum	0.395
72	University of Antwerp	0.396
73	University of Iowa	0.396
74	Banaras Hindu University	0.397
75	London School of Hygiene & Tropical Medicine	0.399
76	University of Florence	0.399
77	Monash University	0.400
78	University of Copenhagen	0.401
79	Centers for Disease Control and Prevention	0.403
80	Medical University of Vienna	0.404
81	National Taiwan University	0.404
82	University of Glasgow	0.406
83	Nanyang Technological University	0.407
84	Manipal Academy of Higher Education	0.411
85	Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam	0.411
86	Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München	0.412
87	AGH University of Krakow	0.413
88	University Hospital Heidelberg	0.414
89	Université Laval	0.414
90	Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona	0.415
91	The University of Sydney	0.415
92	National Research Tomsk State University	0.417
93	Universidade Estadual Paulista (Unesp)	0.418
94	Ministry of Health of the Russian Federation	0.418
95	University of Manchester	0.418
96	Newcastle University	0.418
97	Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf	0.418
98	Radboud University Nijmegen	0.422
99	University of Lisbon	0.423
100	University of Colorado Boulder	0.423
101	Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg	0.423
102	KU Leuven	0.424
103	Sapienza University of Rome	0.424
104	Universidade de São Paulo	0.424
105	University of Liverpool	0.424

MOST STATIONARY slowest institutions per country

evidence ≥ 4,096 records in each half of some year; slowest 16 per country; speed = mean(1−ρ); one shared bar scale

US 2,607 on map

1	Harvard University	0.033
2	Johns Hopkins University	0.063
3	Stanford University	0.069
4	University of Michigan	0.085
5	University of Washington	0.090
6	University of Pennsylvania	0.091
7	National Institutes of Health	0.091
8	Johns Hopkins Medicine	0.095
9	Cornell University	0.097
10	University of California San Diego	0.098
11	Mayo Clinic in Arizona	0.105
12	University of Minnesota	0.105
13	WinnMed	0.106
14	University of Pittsburgh	0.106
15	University of California, Los Angeles	0.109
16	Mayo Clinic	0.110

CN 1,548 on map

1	Chinese Academy of Sciences	0.013
2	Peking University	0.050
3	Shanghai Jiao Tong University	0.051
4	Zhejiang University	0.052
5	Sun Yat-sen University	0.052
6	Sichuan University	0.057
7	University of Chinese Academy of Sciences	0.063
8	Central South University	0.067
9	Jilin University	0.068
10	Huazhong University of Science and Technology	0.069
11	Fudan University	0.072
12	Tsinghua University	0.075
13	Wuhan University	0.081
14	Shandong University	0.081
15	Chinese Academy of Medical Sciences & Peking Union Medical College	0.086
16	West China Hospital of Sichuan University	0.092

FR 1,403 on map

1	Centre National de la Recherche Scientifique	0.012
2	Délégation Paris 7	0.070
3	Délégation Paris 5	0.075
4	Inserm	0.076
5	Sorbonne Paris Cité	0.084
6	CEA Paris-Saclay	0.085
7	Assistance Publique – Hôpitaux de Paris	0.086
8	Institut de Recherche sur les Lois Fondamentales de l'Univers	0.088
9	Institut National de Physique Nucléaire et de Physique des Particules	0.091
10	Commissariat à l'Énergie Atomique et aux Énergies Alternatives	0.105
11	Université Paris Sciences et Lettres	0.107
12	Université Paris Cité	0.110
13	Université Joseph Fourier	0.128
14	Université Paris-Sud	0.131
15	Université Paris-Saclay	0.141
16	Sorbonne Université	0.147

JP 807 on map

1	The University of Tokyo	0.113
2	Kyoto University	0.202
3	The University of Osaka	0.217
4	Keio University	0.256
5	Tohoku University	0.262
6	Kyushu University	0.264
7	Nagoya University	0.265
8	University of Tsukuba	0.278
9	Hokkaido University	0.311

only 9 institutions reach 4,096 records in each half of some year

GB 721 on map

1	University College London	0.057
2	University of Oxford	0.080
3	University of Cambridge	0.110
4	Imperial College London	0.119
5	University of Manchester	0.160
6	University of Edinburgh	0.166
7	King's College London	0.196
8	London School of Hygiene & Tropical Medicine	0.201
9	Queen Mary University of London	0.276
10	University of Liverpool	0.288
11	University of Birmingham	0.317
12	University of Bristol	0.335
13	University of Glasgow	0.346
14	University of Nottingham	0.350
15	University of Sheffield	0.371
16	University of Southampton	0.386

DE 644 on map

1	University Hospital Heidelberg	0.089
2	Heidelberg University	0.097
3	German Cancer Research Center	0.116
4	University Medical Center Hamburg-Eppendorf	0.128
5	LMU Klinikum	0.132
6	Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München	0.147
7	Universität Hamburg	0.149
8	Charité - Universitätsmedizin Berlin	0.162
9	Deutsches Elektronen-Synchrotron DESY	0.173
10	Technical University of Munich	0.186
11	Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin	0.194
12	Freie Universität Berlin	0.213
13	Max Planck Society	0.224
14	RWTH Aachen University	0.232
15	University Hospital Cologne	0.240
16	Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz	0.264

ES 451 on map

1	Instituto de Salud Carlos III	0.084
2	Universitat de Barcelona	0.172
3	Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas	0.206
4	Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona	0.212
5	Universidad Complutense de Madrid	0.213
6	Universidad Autónoma de Madrid	0.235
7	Universitat de València	0.263

only 7 institutions reach 4,096 records in each half of some year

IT 441 on map

1	Istituti di Ricovero e Cura a Carattere Scientifico	0.131
2	Agostino Gemelli University Polyclinic	0.168
3	Vita-Salute San Raffaele University	0.176
4	University of Milan	0.182
5	National Research Council	0.183
6	Sapienza University of Rome	0.187
7	University of Naples Federico II	0.194
8	Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore	0.204
9	University of Bologna	0.282
10	University of Genoa	0.294
11	University of Padua	0.303
12	University of Pisa	0.322
13	University of Florence	0.330
14	University of Turin	0.341

only 14 institutions reach 4,096 records in each half of some year

COLOUR KEY country colours

hue = golden-angle walk in country rank order; count = institutions on the map

US 2,607 · CN 1,548 · FR 1,403 · JP 807 · GB 721 · DE 644 · ES 451 · IT 441 · IN 410 · BR 359 · RU 330 · CA 313 · AU 294 · KR 287 · TW 172 · PL 156 · NL 154 · CH 145 · TR 128 · AR 124 · IR 124 · MX 122 · PT 101 · CZ 99 · AT 93 · BE 93 · SE 83 · GR 77 · NO 68 · UA 62 · DK 55 · ZA 54 · IL 53 · CL 52 · FI 52 · HU 52 · PK 51 · IE 48 · SG 46 · CO 45 · SK 45 · TH 45 · NZ 44 · MY 43 · EG 42 · RO 42 · RS 39 · TN 38 · NG 37 · BG 28 · ID 27 · SA 27 · HR 26 · SI 22 · VN 22 · BD 20 · MA 20 · CU 19 · DZ 19 · KE 19 · BY 16 · HK 15 · PE 13 · GH 11 · LB 11 · LV 11 · NP 11 · PH 11 · UG 11 · AM 10 · EE 10 · JO 10 · LK 10 · LT 10 · VE 10 · CI 9 · CM 9 · KW 9 · LU 9 · QA 9 · UY 9 · AZ 8 · TZ 8 · AE 7 · CR 7 · IS 7 · PR 7 · BF 6 · CY 6 · EC 6 · MD 6 · MN 6 · RE 6 · ET 5 · IQ 5 · MW 5 · MZ 5 · OM 5 · UZ 5 · ZM 5 · BO 4 · GP 4 · KH 4 · ML 4 · MO 4 · SN 4 · BA 3 · BH 3 · BJ 3 · GE 3 · KZ 3 · ME 3 · MG 3 · MT 3 · PA 3 · PY 3 · SD 3 · AL 2 · BW 2 · GA 2 · GF 2 · JM 2 · MK 2 · MM 2 · NC 2 · NI 2 · PF 2 · PG 2 · PS 2 · TT 2 · XK 2 · YE 2 · ZW 2 · AG 1 · BB 1 · BN 1 · CD 1 · CG 1 · CW 1 · DO 1 · FJ 1 · GD 1 · GM 1 · GT 1 · GW 1 · HN 1 · LA 1 · LY 1 · MC 1 · MQ 1 · MU 1 · MV 1 · NE 1 · SO 1 · SS 1 · ST 1 · SY 1 · TG 1 · VG 1